

Be Virtual When Online...

A judge who wanted to blow off steam against some prosecutors unfortunately did so in his MySpace profile. His boss noticed the offending profile and promptly handed the hammer-man marching orders. Moral: never use your real name online. Even if it's YourSpace.



GSOH: Hard To Come By(te)

You can't tell your computer jokes, but the University of Cincinnati has written a program that recognises the humour in puns and wordplay. The folks behind it say it's rudimentary—so it probably won't recognise there's a byte of humour in this sentence. But we'll watch for more.



Escape

THEY DON'T NEED NO EDUCATION

One MPEG Per Child

There's been plenty of news about the OLPC foundation and the laptop design for kids that resulted, and about how children in seventh-world countries are going to gain Wisdom through Education by using those laptops. Wise they have become of what grown-ups do in bed, and Educated they have become as in sex education. Which isn't bad per se, but sex education via porn isn't what the OLPC (One Laptop Per Child) Foundation foresaw, it's not something they liked, and they're going to do something about it.

The news came via the Nigerian News Agency. Formally, they said the laptops that some kids in that country received were being used to surf porn sites. Kids will be kids... in this day and age, of course. These are neo-kids. The folks at *Digit* who pondered this issue only

knew that birds have cloacae, and that bees have a Queen that lays eggs.

So, anyway, reporters from the Agency visited classrooms where the XO operating system fitted laptops were being used. They noticed more flesh on the screens than should have been there, which is almost zero. (Decent folks doing decent things wear clothes.) One of the scribes borrowed a laptop to browse the operating system, and shock came to her vintage mind: sexually-explicit images and videos were stored on it.

As of this writing, efforts are underway to include porn filtering software so the children won't be able to access What Boys Want, involuntarily or otherwise. But we're betting these little perverts will figure a way to bypass the filters. Because kids will be kids... neo-kids, we should say.

KID'S PLAY

Gobbler Hackers Hack Wiki!

In an dizzying display of über-133t hacking skills, a Turkish hacker group going by the deliciously uncreative name of Turkish Professional Hacker Groups defaced the Doctus Information Security Wiki (<http://wiki.doctus.net>).

Now we're not saying we're über-133t hackers ourselves—so we can't LOL too much when a Hacker Group thinks they've Hacked when they haven't. In case this is the first time you're picking up a copy of *Digit*, a wiki is, informally, a Web page anyone can edit. All you need to do is click the Edit button and type away.

That's exactly what these "script kiddies" (hacker-speak for junior or

Whatever Happened To...

Caltiger

Remember the good ol' days just beginning to get affordable. New ISPs sprang up every day and in the melee, a Calcutta (now Kolkata)-based ISP called Caltiger, came up with a cool new idea, called, in short, "free."

Yes, *free* dial-up! It was a huge sensation. Go to www.caltiger.com, register an account, describe your likes, and download the software to access The Free Internet. The software acted as a dialler; it would, umm, also place an ad toolbar on your Desktop.

Users abandoned ship as quickly as they got on. Getting connected was like winning the lottery, and just in case you did, getting a reliable connection was like winning the state lottery and the national lottery on the same day. Add to that the toolbar, which blocked a quarter of the screen; and yes, it was a resource hog too (on the 64 MB RAM machines of the day), causing them to freeze. The company soon walked the plank.

Actually, the idea could never have lasted. Imagine something like that today: we'd probably have a Firefox add-on to get rid of the ads. And there's broadband: no-one would be stuck on dialup just because it was free. And coming down to silly things, there's always the idea of using your monitor's controls to make the screen larger vertically and then moving it down!

Win! My Desktop

No Winner this month! Better luck next time!

Participate in this contest and win next month
Mastering Maya 8.5
by John Kundert-Gibbs
Published by

 WILEY-INDIA



Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.